

Wilson County GIS — Request, Not Purchase Order

Civvix Inc.

September 2026

This replaces the six-layer \$450 order. Nothing on that list is needed to begin. What follows asks for the two things that would genuinely improve the work, and asks for them the way a client's contractor should.

Email — to Wilson County GIS / Planning, copying Aaron Maynard

Subject: GIS layers for the County situs / revenue allocation review

Good morning —

Civvix is supporting Aaron Maynard's office on a local option sales tax situs review for the County. We have already built the geographic baseline from public sources: the Department of Revenue's tax-rate boundary polygons, the Comptroller's certified municipal boundaries, the State NG911 address points, and the Wilson County Emergency Communications District's own published address-point and business-point layers. All 88,196 addresses in the county are placed and measured. We have not needed to purchase anything, and we are not asking the County to spend money.

Two requests, both of which would improve the work:

1. Parcel geometry with assessment attributes. We can obtain Wilson County parcels from the Comptroller's statewide weekly feed, but a copy direct from the County — with the County's own effective date on it — carries more evidentiary weight if a specific situs finding is later contested by a taxpayer or by a city. We would ask that this be provided as County work product in support of the County's own revenue review rather than as a data sale.

2. Boundary currency, which no file can tell us. For Lebanon, Mt. Juliet and Watertown, we need the effective date of the city-limit geometry the County holds, and notice of **any annexation or deannexation adopted by ordinance but not yet reflected in delivered geometry**. This is the single most valuable thing the County can give us and it is not a file — it is knowledge. A situs assignment that is correct against last year's boundary is wrong today.

File Geodatabase is preferred over shapefile where available, as it preserves field names and types. If shapefile is what you have, that is fine.

Happy to share what we have built so you can see how the County's data would be used.

Notes for internal use — do not send

- **Do not open by asking for a fee waiver.** Ask for the layers as County work product. The fee provision at T.C.A. § 10-7-506(c) is triggered by a *request for a copy of a public record*; a county GIS department supporting a county finance review is internal data sharing, and the statute has

no purchase on it. Framing it as a waiver invites the answer “we can’t waive without a written policy.”

- **If they quote the \$75/layer price anyway**, that price is legally defensible and arguing about it is a losing position. Escalate to Aaron instead — it is his department’s budget either way, and the circularity argument is his to make, not yours.
- **Never send a records request on Civvix letterhead.** OORC Advisory Opinion 15-01: corporations are not “citizens” and have no standing under the Tennessee Public Records Act. Any TPRA request must go out in the name of a named Tennessee-resident individual.
- **If you do end up buying**, cite OORC Advisory Opinion 09-02 and decline any licence agreement — a GIS custodian cannot condition the sale on one. That turns a recurring licence into a one-time purchase.
- **What not to ask for, and why:** zoning, water bodies, railroads, contours, subdivisions, commission districts, the thoroughfare plan, and the 2009 building footprints. The footprints in particular are 17 years old; Overture Maps publishes conflated building footprints refreshed monthly, free, under ODbL, and its August 2026 release is current.